

Śrī Mahākāla Nāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 668 · Derge Kangyur

By reciting this, all illness, all epidemics, all malevolent spirits, all harmful beings, all elemental forces, all that have drawn near with harmful intent, and all that have gazed with harmful intent — from above, as high as the realm of the gods who wield power through emanations, and downward — are bound. Below, from the depths of the hells of sentient beings upward, they are bound. And laterally, in every direction all around, as far as the mountains, they are bound.

Furthermore, I am the guardian of temples and maṇḍalas, the physician against the illness of the three poisons, the life-force of all vidyādhara holders, the tutelary deity of all yogins, the lord over all who tame Māra, the one who thoroughly crushes the city of Laṅkāpurī of the rākṣasas, and the one who reduces to dust Vajravīdāraṇī, the lightning-goddess among the daughters of the yakṣas. I have accepted and pledged to protect the teachings of the Three Jewels."

Translator's Notes

- The epithet "सर्वभूतहर्त्रा" refers to the sixth class of desire-realm gods, those who exercise power over others' emanations (Skt. paranirmitavaśavartin). The text specifies binding all harmful forces from this divine level downward to the hells, and laterally to the surrounding mountains — this threefold directionality (above, below, lateral) is a standard formula for totalizing protective scope.

[illegible]

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.